

NOVEL

1. Passage anchor

> “Still, as an occasional read, this kind of **novel** is right up my alley.”

Passage meaning

novel = a long fictional prose book

長篇小說；**小說**

Here, the speaker means this type of fictional book.

Practice

1. I usually read one **novel** every month.

我通常每個月讀一本**小說**。

2. The **novel** explores regret and personal choices.

這本**小說**探討後悔與人生選擇。

Core noun meaning

2. novel — long fictional prose work

= a long written story, usually in prose, with invented characters and events

長篇小說；**小說**

Examples

1. She is writing her first **novel**.

她正在寫她的第一本**長篇小說**。

2. The **novel** was adapted into a film.

這本**小說**被改編成電影。

This is the exact passage sense.

3. novel — literary work as a category

= an individual work belonging to the literary form of the novel

小說作品

Examples

1. It is one of the most influential **novels** of the century.
它是本世紀最具影響力的**小說作品**之一。
2. The course focuses on modern **novels**.
這門課主要研究現代**小說**。

Common types of novel

4. historical novel

= novel set in a historical period

歷史小說

Examples

1. She is reading a **historical novel** set in medieval Europe.
她正在讀一本以中世紀歐洲為背景的**歷史小說**。
2. The author is known for **historical novels**.
這位作者以**歷史小說**聞名。

5. crime / detective novel

= novel centered on crime or investigation

犯罪小說；偵探小說

Examples

1. He enjoys reading **crime novels**.
他喜歡讀**犯罪小說**。
2. The book is a classic **detective novel**.
這本書是經典的**偵探小說**。

6. romance novel

= novel centered mainly on romantic relationships

****愛情小說；言情小說****

Examples

1. She reads a lot of ****romance novels****.
她讀很多****愛情小說****。
2. The story follows the structure of a ****romance novel****.
這個故事採用了****愛情小說****的典型結構。

7. fantasy novel

= novel containing magical or impossible elements

****奇幻小說****

Examples

1. It is a philosophical ****fantasy novel****.
這是一本帶哲思的****奇幻小說****。
2. The series began as a ****fantasy novel****.
這個系列最初是一部****奇幻小說****。

8. graphic novel

= long narrative told through sequential art and text

****圖像小說****

Examples

1. The story was published as a ****graphic novel****.
這個故事以****圖像小說****形式出版。
2. Some ****graphic novels**** deal with very serious themes.
有些****圖像小說****會處理很嚴肅的主題。

Established lexicalized compound.

Adjective meaning: new / original

9. novel — new and unusual

As an adjective:

= new, original, or different from what has been used or known before

****新穎的；創新的；新奇的****

Examples

1. They developed a ****novel approach**** to the problem.

他們提出了一種****新穎的方法****來處理這個問題。

2. The researchers introduced a ****novel technique****.

研究人員引入了一種****創新的技術****。

This is the major second meaning of ****novel****.

10. novel idea / approach / method

= idea or method that is new or original

****新穎的想法 / 方法****

Examples

1. That is a ****novel idea****.

那是一個****新穎的想法****。

2. The team used a ****novel method**** of testing the material.

團隊使用了一種****創新的方法****測試材料。

Very common in academic and formal English.

Scientific / medical use

11. novel — newly identified or newly developed

= new to science, medicine, technology, or a particular field

****新發現的；新型的；新開發的****

Examples

1. Scientists identified a ****novel compound****.

科學家辨識出一種**新型化合物**。

2. The study describes a **novel mechanism**.

這項研究描述了一種**新發現的機制**。

This is the same core adjective sense, but especially common in technical writing.

Related forms

12. novelist

= person who writes novels

小說家

Examples

1. She became a successful **novelist**.

她成為了一位成功的**小說家**。

2. The **novelist** is known for psychological fiction.

這位**小說家**以心理小說聞名。

13. novelistic

= relating to novels, or having qualities typical of a novel

小說的；小說式的

Examples

1. The biography has a **novelistic** style.

這本傳記具有**小說式的**風格。

2. The writer uses **novelistic techniques**.

作者使用了**小說式的敘事技巧**。

14. novelty

A. quality of being new or unusual

新奇；新穎

1. The **novelty** of the idea attracted attention.

這個想法的**新穎性**吸引了注意。

B. something new that is interesting mainly because it is unusual

新奇事物

2. At first, the device was treated as a **novelty**.

起初，這個裝置被當成一種**新奇事物**。

C. novelty item

= small unusual object intended mainly for amusement

新奇小物；趣味商品

3. The shop sells **novelty gifts**.

那家店出售**新奇趣味禮品**。

15. novelty

Rare.

= in a new or original manner

以新穎方式

This is uncommon in ordinary modern English and is low priority.

Key contrasts

16. novel vs fiction

novel

= one long fictional prose work

長篇小說

fiction

= broad category of invented literature

虛構文學

So:

> a novel is usually fiction

but:

> fiction also includes short stories and other forms.

17. novel vs book

****book****

= any bound or digital written work

****書****

****novel****

= specifically a long fictional narrative

****小說****

A textbook, biography, dictionary, or cookbook is a ****book****, but not a ****novel****.

18. novel vs story

****story****

= narrative of events; can be short or long, real or fictional

****故事****

****novel****

= long fictional prose work

****長篇小說****

19. novel vs new

****new****

= recently created, obtained, introduced, etc.

****新的****

****novel****

= not merely new, but notably original or unusual

****新穎的；創新的****

Compare:

> a new phone

> 一部新手機

> a novel solution

> 一個新穎的解決方法

Not every ****new**** thing is ****novel****.

20. novel vs innovative

****innovative****

= introducing useful new ideas or methods

****創新的****

****novel****

= new and unusual; does not necessarily imply proven usefulness

****新穎的****

Compare:

> a novel concept

> 一個新穎概念

> an innovative product

> 一款創新的產品

21. novel vs original

****original****

= not copied; independently created

****原創的 ; 獨創的****

****novel****

= new or unusual compared with what existed before

****新穎的****

They overlap, but the emphasis differs.

Meaning map

The word **novel** has two major modern branches:

Noun

novel

→ **長篇小說**

From this:

* historical novel → **歷史小說**

* crime novel → **犯罪小說**

* fantasy novel → **奇幻小說**

* graphic novel → **圖像小說**

* novelist → **小說家**

Adjective

novel

→ **新穎的；創新的；新奇的**

From this:

* novel idea → **新穎想法**

* novel approach → **創新方法**

* novel technique → **新技術 / 新穎技術**

* novelty → **新奇；新穎性**

The passage uses the **noun** branch:

> “this kind of **novel**”

> → **這一類小說**

MCQ-ready master list

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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novel — noun	以虛構人物和事件構成的長篇散文故事；長篇小說
novel — literary work	屬於小說這種文學形式的一部作品
historical novel	以某個歷史時期為背景的歷史小說
crime/detective novel	以犯罪、偵查或解謎為中心的犯罪 / 偵探小說
romance novel	以愛情關係為主要內容的愛情小說
fantasy novel	含有魔法、不現實等奇幻元素的小說
graphic novel	主要以連續圖像配合文字講述長篇故事的圖像小說
novel — adjective	相對於既有做法而言新而不尋常的；新穎的 / 創新的

novel idea/approach/method	新穎、以前較少見的想法 / 方法	
novel — technical/scientific	新發現、新辨識或新開發的	
novelist	創作小說的作家；小說家	
novelistic	與小說有關或具有小說敘事特色的	
novelty — newness	新穎、新奇這種特質	
novelty — unusual thing	因新奇或罕見而引人注意的事物	
novelty item	主要因趣味、新奇而售賣的小商品	

Passage recap

> “Still, as an occasional read, this kind of **novel** is right up my alley.”

Here:

novel = **a long fictional prose work**

Best Traditional Chinese:

* **小說**

* **長篇小說**

Natural contextual translation:

即便如此，作為偶爾閱讀的一種選擇，這類小說真的很合我口味。

Passage MCQ-ready meaning

novel

= **a long fictional story written in prose**

長篇小說；小說

The crucial polysemy distinction is:

> a **novel**

> → 一本小說

but:

> a **novel approach**

> → 一種**新穎**的方法

So compare:

> I read a **novel**.

> → 我讀了一本**小說**。

> They proposed a **novel** solution.

> → 他們提出了一個**新穎的**解決方案。

Same spelling and pronunciation, but a clear **noun vs adjective meaning split**.